

Naloxone

(Narcan)

I. Classification

- Opioid antagonist

II. Action(s)

- Competes for opioid receptor sites

III. Indication(s)

- Complete or partial reversal of narcotic depression (depressed mental status or respiratory rate < 10) induced by narcotics

IV. Contraindications

- Hypersensitivity

V. Precautions

- Duration of action of some narcotics may exceed that of Narcan
- Use cautiously in patients with cardiovascular disease
- Use of Narcan can precipitate acute narcotic withdrawal – use cautiously in patients with known narcotic dependency
- Narcan should ONLY be used if narcotic use / overdose is suspected AND the patient has signs / symptoms of CNS and/or respiratory depression

VI. Drug interactions

- None significant

VII. Adult Dosing and Administration

- 2 mg IV / IO / IM / IN, repeat x1 after 2-3 minutes if indicated
- Consult On-Call Medical Director for additional doses

VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration

- Autoinjector: 1mg IN/IM
 - Repeat in 2-3 min x 1 to improve ventilation/respiratory effort
- 0.1 mg/kg IV / IO / IM / IN (max dose 2 mg), repeat x1 after 2-3 minutes if indicated
- Consult On-Call Medical Director for additional doses

IX. Onset

- Within 2 minutes

X. Duration

- 30 minutes – 2 hours

XI. Possible Adverse Effects

- Nausea and vomiting
- Yawning and piloerection (goose-bumps)
- Tachycardia, hypertension, hypotension, cardiac arrhythmias
- Tremulousness
- Seizures